

What happened to the bowhead?

The bowhead was hunted almost to extinction in the 1800s, largely for its baleen, which can grow to more than 10 ft (3 m). It is thought that current population levels are around 7,000—from around 30,000 in the 1850s.



The bowhead has the longest baleen of any whale. It hangs from the whale's upper jaw.



If a whale is caught in a fishing net and cannot surface, it will drown.